

Miner Hardballers Open Second Half

Injury-riddled University of Texas at El Paso begins the second half of conference play Friday against Arizona needing only one victory to set the school record for most baseball victories in a season.

The Miners are 26-18 for the season and 2-7 in Western Athletic Conference play following last weekend's three-game series in Albuquerque where UTEP won one and dropped two games to New Mexico.

Finding that one victory in the 1 p.m. contest at Dudley Field may be somewhat of a task for the Miners who have recently lost the services of regular leftfielder Danny Haygood and backup outfielder Art Flores with shoulder separations.

Second baseman Art Bravo's services are also questionable. The UTEP captain pulled a hamstring several weeks ago and his availability is a day-to-day question mark for Coach Andy Cohen.

"We're really hurting in the outfield. Losing Haygood really hurts us because of his speed and his bat," said Cohen Thursday.

Haygood's departure for the remainder of the season leaves UTEP with four outfielders and utility infielder Orlando Cordova who has had outfield experience in the past.

"We'll probably put Bill Roberts in right and move Dan Feagler to left," said Cohen.

One of UTEP's two WAC victories was against Arizona in Tucson two weeks ago. Since then, the Wildcats hit a torrid slump by losing three straight games to rival Arizona State, thus dropping Arizona's conference record to 5-4 behind the Southern Division leading Sun Devils.

The last time Arizona came to town, the Miners pulled off a double upset by sweeping a twinbill in 1977.

"We're hurting a little but by no means are we giving up," added Cohen. "When we beat Arizona over in Tucson, our boys acted like we had just won the World Series. They know what it takes to beat a good team like Arizona."

Jim Sacco, supporting a 5-3 record and a strikeout ratio of little more than one per inning is scheduled to start on the mound for the Miners.

Both teams will return to Dudley Field for a Saturday doubleheader beginning at 11 a.m.

WAC BASEBALL STANDINGS (Southern Division)

	W	L	Pct.	W	L	Pct.
Arizona State	38	6	.864	9	0	1.000
Arizona	31	10	.756	5	4	.555
UTEP	26	18	.591	2	7	.222

(Northern Division)

	W	L	Pct.	W	L	Pct.
Brigham Young	27	9	.750	9	0	1.000
Utah	5	19	.220	3	5	.375
Wyoming	20	20	.500	3	6	.333
Colorado State	15	18	.454	2	6	.250

Last Week's Results

Arizona State 15-10-11, Arizona 9-8-10, New Mexico 9-6-2, UTEP 4-8-0, Brigham Young 8-9-20, Wyoming 2-3-8, Utah 9-7, Colorado State 3-11.

Friday's Games

Arizona at UTEP, Arizona State at New Mexico, Brigham Young at Utah, Colorado State at Wyoming (2).

Saturday's Games

Arizona at UTEP (2), Arizona State at New Mexico (2), Brigham Young at Utah, Colorado State at Wyoming